



Section4 Product Sprint

ARMOIRE: Closet of the Future

Strategic Competitor Recommendations
by Joanne Donohue, Product Manager



SECTION 4

IT'S RENTED



ARMOIRE

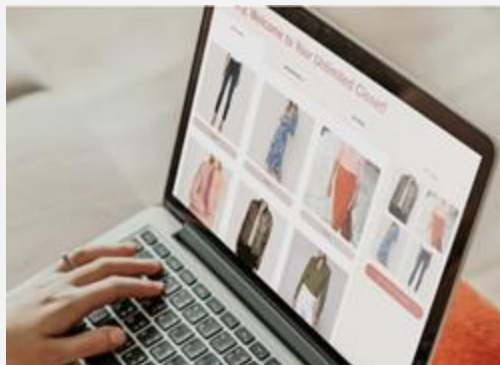
WARDROBE-AS-SERVICE SUBSCRIPTION STARTUP FOR TODAY'S BOSSLADY

Singh launched Armoire while at MIT's Delta V accelerator program and has since raised \$5.1 million from investors. Last year, Armoire experienced triple-digit sales growth and opened a brick-and-mortar headquarters in Pioneer Square, Seattle. The startup has 35 full-time employees and 90 percent of its workforce is female.



AMBIKA SINGH

Founder



CORE

Effortless confidence
for powerful women

ACTUAL

Technology-led clothing
rental subscription service

AUGMENTED

Personal Stylist, free dry
cleaning, community, events

FEATURES & BENEFITS



Sustainable

New outfit for every
occasion, Ethically sourced
clothing



AI Powered

Designer wardrobe curated
by proprietary algorithm



Fairy Godmother

Real-life personal stylist
at popup locations or
virtually online



Hassle-free

Delivered to you,
free dry cleaning and
alterations



Love it? Keep it!

Deep discounts, applied
to your account in app



#bosslady Community

Community of professional women,
customer newsfeed, feature
women-owned clothing brands



NICHE: POWER WOMEN



"I'm running from the boardroom to charity events and I need a savvy clothing solution to match my energy."

DEMOGRAPHICS

Age: 28 - 52

Gender: Female

Location: Seattle, SF, Portland

Career: Tech, C-Suite, Finance

CUSTOMER STATISTICS



40% in Seattle

Before Armoire:



Spent 200 hr / yr shopping



Bought 60 clothing items / yr



#whorunsttheworldgirls





WHAT SETS ARMOIRE APART?



CROWDSOURCE FIT & STYLE DATA

Algorithm learns customer preference over time through voluntary, frictionless surveys upon item return. While not the most fashion-based approach, the model considers fit and how the fabric drapes on the body over the numerical size on the label. Creates look-alike groups to recommend pieces to others with similar taste profile and measurements.

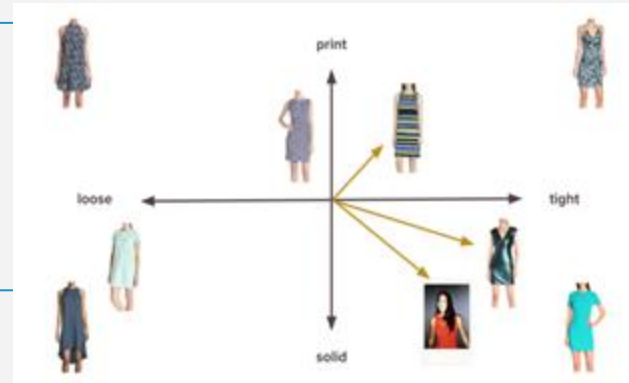
RECOMMENDATION SYSTEM THROUGH VECTOR MODELING

Complex model maps customer preferences against item attributes to recommendations items women love. Netflix uses a similar model.



CONTEXT

Armoire leverages weather and geo-local information to curate clothing for the situation. Subscribers can also reach out to a stylist via live chat function for vacations and trips.





COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

	COMPETITORS	RECOMMENDATIONS
NARROW	Rent the Runway, Le Tote, Vince Unfold	Little differentiation in Actual and Augmented product, take credit for cutting edge tech powering the site (Armoire's secret sauce)
FORM	StitchFix, Nordstrom, The RealReal, consignment shops	Fashion is a large, fragmented market quickly moving to ecom, with a new focus on sustainability- it's not a unique value proposition anymore
NEED	Accessories, Pinterest, networking events	Expand into statement-making jewelry and handbags, host local events focused beyond fashion topics
RESOURCE	Data (Amazon Fashion), Time & Attention	Reduce friction in voluntary data collection and gamify shopper insights, lean into local connections in niche market to combat scale players





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FIGHTING NARROW & FORM COMPETITION IS A LOSING PROPOSITION

RENT THE RUNWAY



Many substitutes exist in the marketplace with same features, at a similar price point

→ Lean into Boss Lady narrative, continue to feature powerful women like VP Kamala Harris and founder story. Don't try to be everybody.

Most substitutes function as ecommerce site, relying on basic filters and meta-tags (color, tagged size)

→ Boast about the technology that sits behind the pretty clothes, the niche customer is sophisticated and tech savvy. They get it.

→ Feature “measured life” metrics front and center, this niche has an Apple Watch and a Peloton.



Joanne's

2020 Year in Review

44
brands

\$17,729
worth of clothing

62
styles

Top Brands

1. French Connection
2. Nicole Miller Atelier
3. Tart
4. Yumi Kim
5. Boden

Most-Rented Item

Event Dresses 

Favorite Pattern

Floral 

Go-to Color

Black 



FIGHTING NARROW & FORM COMPETITION IS A LOSING PROPOSITION

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NORDSTROM

“It is our hope that together with our customers, we can work toward a more sustainable future for us and generations to come.”

—PETE NORDSTROM

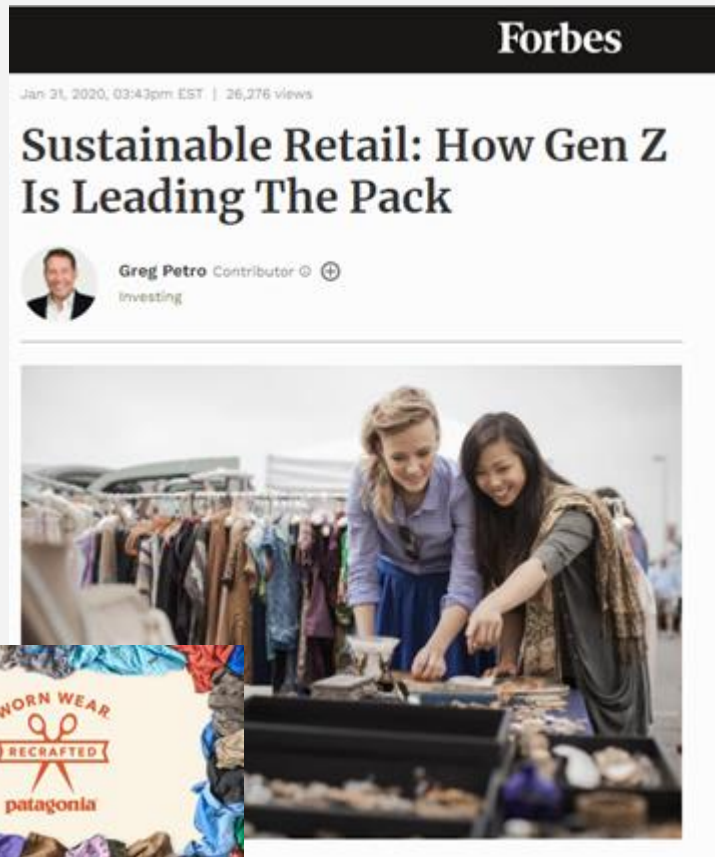


Sustainability is IN, every retailer is talking about it.

→ Reusable delivery packaging and a message around saving the environment are table stakes, especially with younger consumers.

High-earning woman have grown accustomed to one day delivery. I want it and I want now.

→ While home delivery and free dry cleaning are great features, the modern ecom consumer has every need catered to by fashion brands and Amazon alike. This is not a point of differentiation.





GO LOCAL TO FIGHT NEED COMPETITION

NEED



@twyladilldesign
Pike Place Market, Seattle



Beat Pinterest, Instagram in "fashion inspiration" market

→ Continue to feature real customers wearing the garments throughout the web experience. This niche appreciates marketing material displaying all ages and body types, sans photoshop.

Show-stopping accessories drive confidence

→ Partner with female artisans in Seattle, Portland and SF. Make their jewelry, handbags and scarves available on site to fight scale competitors. Tell their story.

Armoire's empowered female niche yearns for community involvement and events, fashion is secondary for this group.

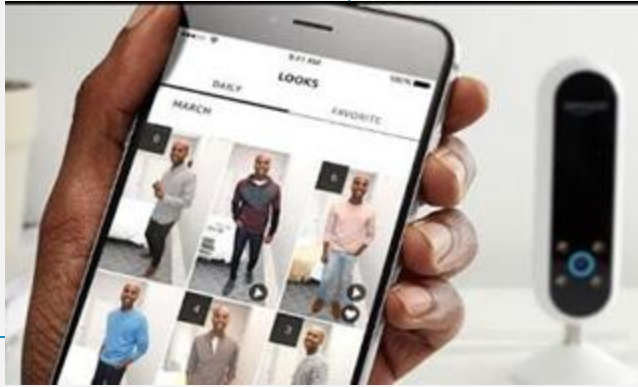
→ Hold events that go beyond styling sessions and fashion shows. They want to meet other REAL women and make professional connections. Be the facilitator for tech, start-up and finance meetups in core markets.





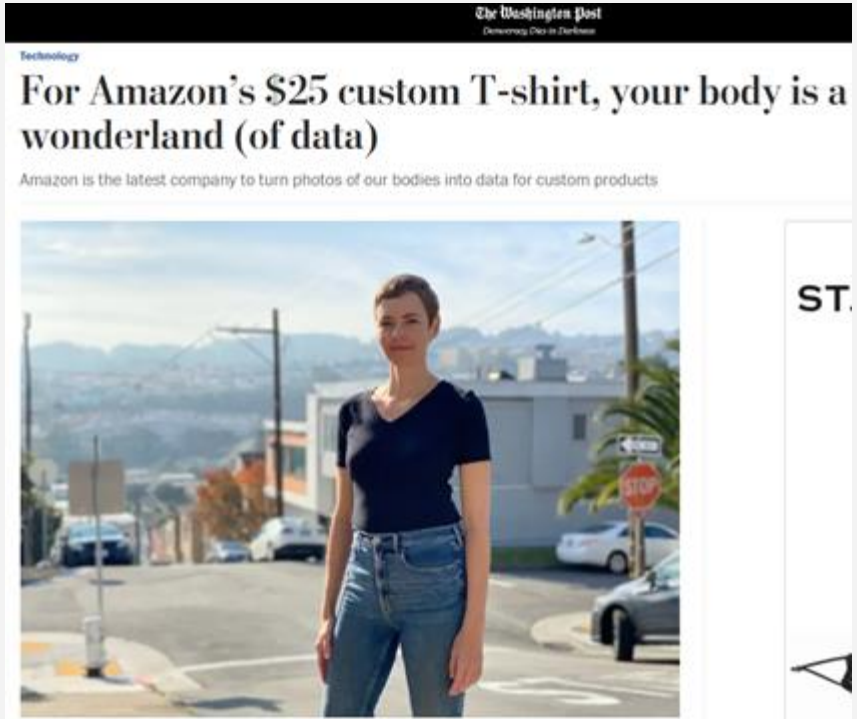
RESOURCE COMPETITION IS THE BIGGEST THREAT, FOCUS HERE

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Armoire's secret sauce is also its biggest risk - data. Amazon is king of data and they know EVERYTHING about their Prime members (Amazon's echo Look device featured above)

- Gamify the data collection experience to incentivize the busy professional woman through free items and fun stats (\$ value of rented clothing, fave brands & useful feedback)
- While Amazon can win on scale and operational excellence, Armoire beats out the ecom giant on personality and connection. Lean in to the Boss Lady news feed and local events to differentiate.



In Dec 2020, Amazon launched personalized clothing brand "Made for You" using exact measurements

- Continue to seek out women owned brands with unique designs, the Armoire customer wants to stand out from the crowd and feel empowered in her armour.



SPECIAL THANKS TO ARMOIRE FOR
MAKING MY CLUELESS CLOSET
DREAMS COME TRUE!

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<https://www.armoire.style/closet>

Template by: <http://slidesgo.com/>